time of the Upanishad, of the Buddha, or the later classical age were to be set down in modern I n d i a . . . h e would see his race clinging to forms and shells and rags of the past and missing nine-tenths of its nobler m e a n i n g . . .he would be amazed by the extent of the mental poverty, the immobility, the static repetition, the cessation of science, the long sterility of art, the comparative feebleness of the creative intuition.'

M a t e r i a l i s m

One of our major misfortunes is that we have lost so much of the world's ancient literature—in Greece, in India, and elsewhere. Probably this was inevitable as these books were originally written on plam-leaves or on *bhurjapatra,* the thin layers of the bark of the birch tree which peel off" so easily, and later on paper. There were only a few copies of a work in existence and if they were lost or destroyed, that work disappeared, and it can only be traced by references to it, or quotations from it, in other books. Even so, about fifty or sixty thousand manuscripts in Sanskrit or its variations have already been traced and listed and fresh discoveries are being constantly made. Many old Indian books have so far not been found in India at all but